

GLP-1 medication insurance coverage

GLP-1 medications are available by prescription only. FDA-approved GLP-1 medications specifically for weight loss are often excluded from insurance coverage.

What you should know:

If your insurance does cover GLP-1 medications for weight loss you should expect an authorization process. This can include documentation of:

- Previous weight-loss efforts
- Your body mass index (BMI)
- Health-related conditions

Your insurance company may have a preferred pharmacy, which can include a mail medication delivery. Often this can offer better pricing.

Sources

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- Jastreboff AM, et al. N Engl M Med. 2022
- Davies MJ, et al. Jama 2015
- Rubino, et al. Jama 2022
- He, et al. JAMA Intern Med 2022
- Rubino et al. Jama 2021



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TECHNICAL WRITING



Considering GLP-1 Medications for Weight Loss?

What you should know and how to talk to your healthcare provider



The information contained in this brochure is for informational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice. Talk to your healthcare provider to learn more about GLP-1 medications for weight loss and whether or not they are right for you.

What are GLP-1 medications?

GLP-1s (glucagon-like peptide-1 receptor agonists) are lab-made versions of a natural protein produced in your intestine. This protein helps control blood sugar and appetite.

Another protein, called GIP, works in a similar way. Newer medications now combine GLP-1 and GIP to improve blood sugar and support weight loss.

GLP-1s are very effective at helping patients lose weight. Weight loss ranges from 5-21% of total body weight in clinical trials.

These are the most common GLP-1s used for weight loss*:

Wegovy (Semaglutide GLP-1)

Wegovy is available as a weekly injectable medication or a daily oral pill.

Zepbound (Tirzepatide GLP-1/GIP)

Zepbound is available only as a weekly injectable medication.

*FDA approved medications for weight management

Side effects



Nausea, vomiting, constipation, or diarrhea are common side effects of GLP-1 medications.



Disease of the gallbladder and bile drainage system is about 1.5 times more common in GLP-1 patients than placebo.



Muscle loss can occur concurrently with fat loss.

Unknown risks



It is unknown if GLP-1 medications cause eye damage in non-diabetic patients.



It is unknown if GLP-1 medications have any effect on bone health or fracture risk.

Weight regain



Studies have shown there is a real risk of weight regain following GLP-1 discontinuation. Lifestyle interventions should be an integral part of weight loss maintenance, though it's possible you will require lifelong medication to maintain your weight loss.

Ready to speak with your healthcare provider about a GLP-1 medication for weight loss?

Pre-appointment checklist:

- ☐ Make a list of diets or exercise programs you have participated in, and for how long.
- ☐ Know your other medical conditions.
- ☐ Research if your insurance plan covers GLP-1s specifically for weight loss.
- ☐ Determine if you can afford out-of-pocket costs (up to ~\$1000/month)

Ask your healthcare provider:

- ☐ How can I minimize gastrointestinal side effects?
- ☐ How can I minimize muscle loss?
- ☐ How long will I have to take medication?
- ☐ What will I do if it doesn't work?